Auctions - Models and Bid endpoint

Context

You're building a backend service for an auction platform. This is a scoped take-home exercise - focus your time on the core logic and the specific scenarios listed below rather than things like authentication, rate limiting, deployment or infrastructure.

What to build

A small bidding endpoint for an auction system.

- POST /bid (accepting auction_id, user_id, amount)

No schema is provided - design your own data model for auctions and bids, and use it in your implementation.

- Only strictly higher bids than the current top bid should be accepted.
- There must be no ambiguity about an auction's current top bid.
- A bid may arrive at the exact moment the auction closes - your design should define what happens in this case.
- A bid request may be sent more than once and users may bid on an auction where they are already the current top bidder - decide how your system handles this and why.

Stack: Any language / framework you're comfortable with.

How to submit

- Push your work to a git repo
    - It can be a public link
    - Or share access with the username thealphaversion as a collaborator (if you're using Github)
    - Let us know if you need help with this.
- Write a readme on how to run it.
- [Optional] We have a minimal node.js starter template if you'd like to use it: https://github.com/thealphaversion/node-assignment-template (Please fork it instead of cloning it if you do end up using it)

Include with your submission (Required)

Please do not use AI for these answers - we'd like to know what you think

- Your data model and why you structured it that way.
- How you handled the auction-close boundary case.
- How you handled a request to place a new bid and why.
- What you decided for a user bidding on their own current top bid, and why.
- Think of one part of this assignment that you think is wrong, underspecified, or would cause a problem in production - and what you'd change.
- Please also mention this assignment id in your Readme.md - v#hdf38%44